A Little Sweet, a Little Heat Soup

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Sweet potatoes and carrots make a beautifully velvety soup, with ginger, curry and peanut butter bringing warmth and depth.

Serves 6–8 · Prep 20 min · Cook 35 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE SOUP

- 2 tbsp coconut oil
- 1 tbsp butter
- ½ cup chopped onion
- 1 tbsp finely grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp curry powder
- 3 cups peeled, diced carrots
- 4 cups peeled, diced sweet potatoes
- 4 cups vegetable broth, plus extra if needed
- ½ cup peanut butter
- 1 cup coconut cream
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper, to taste
- Hot sauce, to taste

TO SERVE

- Sourdough bread, sliced *(optional)*
- Olive oil, for brushing *(optional)*
- Crisp bacon crumbs, optional

METHOD

1. Soften the onion. Heat the coconut oil and butter in a large, heavy saucepan over medium heat. Add the onion and cook for approximately 5 minutes, until softened.
2. Add the aromatics. Stir in the ginger and curry powder. Cook for approximately 30 seconds to 1 minute, stirring, until fragrant.
3. Simmer the vegetables. Add the carrots and sweet potatoes, stirring to coat them in the spices. Pour in the vegetable broth and bring to a gentle boil. Reduce the heat, cover and simmer for approximately 25–30 minutes, until the vegetables are very tender. Add a little extra broth if needed to keep them mostly submerged.
4. Blend. Stir in the peanut butter, then remove from the heat. Blend with a hand blender until completely smooth.
5. Finish the soup. Return to low heat and stir in the coconut cream. Warm gently, adding more broth if needed to reach your preferred consistency. Season with salt, black pepper and hot sauce.
6. Toast the sourdough. Brush the bread lightly with olive oil and toast in a hot frying pan or under the grill until golden on both sides.
7. Ladle the soup into bowls. Finish with crisp bacon crumbs, if using, and serve with the toasted sourdough.

Tip

Cut the vegetables evenly. Small, similar-sized pieces cook more quickly and blend smoothly.